



Wāndyr

an Adventure Game



Wândyr, an Adventure Game

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About the Name: Wândyr is “wander” as in travel about, but also “wonder” as in finding wondrous things in your travels, and maybe bringing them back.

Contents

Welcome to Wåndyr!	2
Starting a Game	4
The Muster	7
Camping	8
Advancement	8
Experience	8
Party Level	9
Game Play	9
Ask the Oracle	9
Time	10
Music	10
Names	11
Måjic	11
Magic Items	11
Magic-Users	12
Invocations	17
Monsters	17
Fighting	18
The Oracle	19
Insight	19

Welcome to Wåndyr!

Wåndyr is an adventure game about a band of adventurers wandering through a pulp fantasy world. The focus is on exploration, following rumors, discovering new places, finding magic, treasure hunting, camping, singing, storytelling, cleverly overcoming impossible odds, and coming back alive with tales to tell. In the spirit of *The Hobbit*, Wåndyr celebrates the journey of going there and back again.

The stories and songs of your characters emerge during play, filled with wonder and surprises that even the Guide doesn't anticipate.

Sandbox

The Guide describes the world but doesn't create a story beforehand. The local area remains wide open and undefined, even if some aspects of the wider world are known. This "sandbox" style allows everyone at the table to discover the unexpected together.

The Guide uses dice rolls and random tables to determine what happens rather than telling a predetermined story. Each new discovery adds to the growing lore of your campaign world.



The Oracle

The **Oracle** answers any yes/no question instantly, often adding unexpected "sweet" or "spicy" flavor to keep adventures surprising. Both Guide and players consult the Oracle during play.

For deeper questions, the Oracle excels at "20 questions" to reveal mysteries piece by piece. The Guide should also use the random tables in the **Wåndyr World Oracle**.

Wåndyr is compatible with most Old School Roleplaying (OSR) games, but with fresh mechanics. Thus, the Guide has a wealth of material to augment the Oracle.

Starting a Game

Wândyr is a game played with friends. Select one person to be the Guide; the other people are players.

1 - Starting Location

The Guide describes the starting location for the adventure, such as a medieval tavern in a town on the borderlands. The Guide can place this into a larger fantasy world, or let that be a mystery for now.

2 - Create Characters

Each player needs three characters. A character has two Traits and two Skills, for example:

LINDON: BRAVE, STRONG | POLEAX, ARMOR



2 - Select a Rumor

The Guide then lists a few rumors that hint about troublesome events in the area or interesting places to explore. The players choose a rumor to follow.

3 - Muster a Character

Each player rolls 1d6 Hearts for each of their characters and chooses one to "Muster" (play). From now on, each player becomes their mustered character. The Guide gives new characters 1-4 basic "hand me down" items for weapons, armor, tools, spellbooks, etc.

4 - Pack for the Journey

The Guide should provide a landmark or general directions so the path of the journey is clear, and provide or suggest basic travel supplies (e.g. food, water, traveling cloak). Players can swap items amongst themselves, but must leave unnecessary items behind with their other characters.

5 - Embark

Start play on the road. Each player plays their mustered character; the Guide handles everything else.



Characters

Each character starts with two Traits and two Skills.

ROOK: AGILE THIEF | KNIFE, (LOCKPICKS)

Rook is played as an “agile thief” (Traits) and knows how to use a knife and *secretly lockpicks* (Skills).

Traits

A Trait is a keyword that describes how the character is *played*.

Each Trait must be a single word, or common compound word (e.g. “rat-catcher”, “horse-thief”). Traits can describe approaches to solving problems, values, personality, habits, physical appearance, etc. Traits can alternatively refer to a culture, homeland, or ancestry (human, elf, dwarf, etc.) if that helps the player paint a vivid character sketch. Good Traits make the character fun and distinctive to play.

Traits do not say “what you know”, rather they say “how you behave”.

Skills

A Skill is something the character has learned, either an item

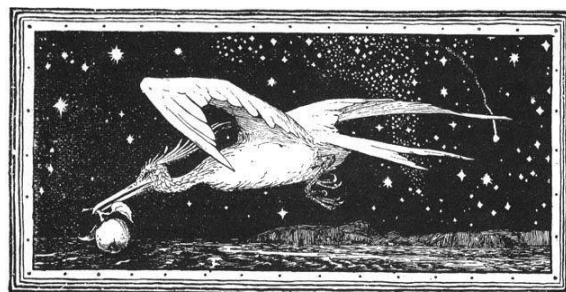
proficiency or a knowledge.

Examples: dagger, longsword, bow, lockpicks, shield, armor, type of animal, spellbook, wand, arcane staff, harp, bushcraft, etc.

Attempting to use *specialized* items or knowledge always requires a *specialized* Skill, such as “greatsword”, “herbal medicine”, or a magic school. Characters can only start with one *specialized* Skill.

Names

New characters are novices who have yet to earn experience, accomplish heroic deeds, or build a legend. If they accomplish these in play they can earn Names. Each Name can be a byname (title the character goes by), performance (song, story, ballad, poem, etc.), magic spell, or special ability (thief skill, berserker rage, etc).



Example Characters

Choose or roll d66, or mix n' match parts. The format is **Alias: Traits | Skills**, with Songs in quotes.

1.1 Rook: agile cunning | knife, (lockpicks)

1.2 Cipher: calculating elusive | ciphers,
daggers

1.3 Shadow: silent (ruthless) | blowgun,
poisons

1.4 Wilde: charming strong | cards, cutlass

1.5 Lyra: nimble (spy) | rope, spy ciphers

1.6 Pearl: deadly noble | disguise kit,
(stiletto)

2.1 Serra: fierce shieldmaiden | battle ax,
shield

2.2 Magnus: strong, boisterous | warhammer,
armor

2.3 Iron: tough dwarf | axe, shield

2.4 Sarge: grizzled soldier | arming sword,
armor

2.5 Pike: alert guard | halberd, whistle

2.6 Shiro: honorable lethal | katana,
wakizashi

3.1 Drake: weathered wanderer | machete,
tinderbox

3.2 Slate: observant scout | telescope, bow

3.3 Wolf: (feral) hunter | spear, "Song of the
Wild"

3.4 Hawk: vigilant scout | longbow,
falconry-glove

3.5 Storm: impetuous, daring | javelin,
grapnel

3.6 Echo: hallow elf | harp | "Elven Ballad of
Hope"

4.1 Kat: lithe second-story-thief | (grappling
hook, thieves tools)

4.2 Forge: steadfast armorer | armor,
hammer

4.3 Quill: meticulous learned | ledger, inkwell

4.4 Flint: steely dwarf | axe, cookpot

4.5 Nails: tough soldier | flail, gambeson

4.6 Lindon: brave, strong | poleax, armor

5.1 Khael: focused witch-hunter |
umbrakalla binding chains

5.2 Vesper: artistic scholar | illusion staff

5.3 Twilight: pensive devious | umbrakalla
sickle

5.4 Istar: honorable white-wizard | vitae
staff

5.5 Hezerek: ambitious (shady) | umbrakalla
orb

5.6 Ignus: fiery driven | elementale staff

6.1 Dusk: honorable noble | ancestral blade,
doublet

6.2 Oak: strong enduring | staff, rope

6.3 Vale: woodcraft hunter | longbow, knife

6.4 Digs: dwarf prospector | pickaxe, mining
helmet

6.5 Bear: strong warrior | maul, bearskin
cloak

6.6 Thalia: keen-eyed elf | bow, sword

The Muster

Ok boys, check your kit, check your weapons, it's today. You get a pint and a chaser, no more. Let's go.

During the Muster, each player takes on the role of one character adventuring today. The Guide provides new characters with 1-4 basic "hand me down" items.

Hearts

Players roll 1d6 Hearts for each of their three characters, and choose one who answers the Muster and will be played today.

If the character party advances above 1st level, then roll 1d6 Hearts per Party Level. For example, at 2nd level each character rolls 2d6 Hearts.

10 Item Slots

Each character has 10 Item Slots to hold gear they have "equipped" and can access and use easily.

Each slot can hold one small item (cloak, flask, tinderbox, flask, 1 day rations, torch, coin purse, arrow quiver, lockpicks) or a bundle of tiny identical items (bowstrings, gems).

Larger items use 1-4 Item Slots:

- ❖ **Weapons:** dagger 1, sword 2, halberd 3, pike 4
- ❖ **Bows:** arrow quiver 1, bow 2, crossbow 3, arbalest 4

- ❖ **Shields:** buckler 1, heater 2, round shield 3, tower shield 4
- ❖ **Armor:** gauntlets 1, helm 2, gambeson 3, haubergeon 4
- ❖ **Musical Instrument:** pipe 1, lute 2, guitar 3, war drums 4

Baggage

Characters can carry gear outside of their 10 Item Slots but must keep a separate list called "Baggage" (big bags or rucksacks). Accessing an item from Baggage takes d6 Turns. Baggage halves movement and causes safety issues when swimming, leaping, climbing, etc.

Home Base

The characters are part of an "adventuring party" with a "home base". They might be an adventurers guild, warband, canting crew, etc. Their base could be a tavern, flat house, hideout, etc.



Camping

In Wândyr, each game starts with a Muster and ends in Camp. When the adventuring party decides to stop and rest, they must choose whether to make a temporary camp or return home.

Downtime

Camping is downtime. Each character exits play until the next time they Muster. The game is essentially “paused”, allowing the players and Guide to openly and rapidly discuss topics that might be more difficult to do when actively playing a character. For example, at this time the Guide awards XP and players can spend XP. The party may also fast-forward in time.

Comforts

The comforts of home are cheerful companions. A wheel of cheese, a crusty bread, mead, wine, or a good smoke can make even the most dismal dungeon feel fine.

A character who consumes a Comfort during Muster receives up to 2 extra Hearts. A 1-Heart comfort is 10 gp and uses 1 slot; a 2-Heart is 100 gp and 2 slots. Comforts are available in taverns, inns, and provisioners, or might be found.

Advancement

New characters are unproven, untested novices with no prior experience, heroic deeds. *All this must develop during the game.*

Experience

Characters can earn Experience Points (XP) from their adventures. They can earn 1-6 XP for following their currently selected rumor to its full conclusion. They can also earn 1 XP by discovering an important new location or magical feature, map a new region, experimenting with magic, or rescuing captives. *Slaying monsters and looting treasure never directly earns XP.*

Spending XP

Characters in Camp can spend XP to buy Traits, Skills, and Names. Simply, gaining a new thing costs XP equal to the new number of that kind of thing. For example, gaining the 1st Name costs 1 xp, and gaining the 3rd Trait costs 3 xp.

Earning Names

Characters are only eligible to take a Name after accomplishing a significant deed during play. For example, a character must cast a spell from a book *with Sweet* before they can learn it. After buying it with XP, the character can either keep the Name for themselves or assign it to an item (creating a “Named

Item"). *It can be fun to hire an artisan to inscribe an item with its Names and decorations (inlays, etchings, gems, gold leaf, etc.).*

Party Level

The adventuring party has a shared "Party Level", which starts at 1st level. Characters roll 1d6 Hearts per Party Level when mustering. The Guide can also use Party Level when setting the Oracle target.

Level	Gold	Hearts	Reputation
1	0	1d6	Cads
2	2,000	2d6	Culls
3	4,000	3d6	Rogues
4	8,000	4d6	Coves
5	16,000	5d6	Scoundrels
6	32,000	6d6	Wayfarers
7	64,000	7d6	Adventurers
8	125,000	8d6	Explorers
9	250,000	9d6	Voyagers
10	500,000	10d6	Wāndyrers

Party Level is shared by all characters who are from the same Home Base. Characters can advance their Party Level to Level 2 by paying 2,000 gp to improve their base; the cost doubles for each Level (4,000 total for level 3, and so on). *The gold is presumed spent on improvements to "home base", hiring trainers, throwing parties, etc.*

Game Play

The game mostly consists of a conversation around the table where people ask questions.

When a player asks a question about a *fact* yet unknown, the Guide asks the Oracle:

- "Is this town on a waterway?"
- "Is there a trail in the woods?"
- "Do they seem friendly?"

When a player takes action, the Guide or player asks the Oracle:

- "I flee and climb a tree!"
- "I throw my spear"
- "I parry with my shield!"

Ask the Oracle

Speak a question such as "does my spear hit the foe?" and roll 2d6: on 8 or higher it's "Yes", otherwise "No".

Advantage/Disadvantage

With Advantage, roll 3d6 and keep the two best dice (on Disadvantage keep the two worst). Never remove a 1 from the roll (e.g. 1, 1, 6 = 8).

Advantage can be gained with clever play or **Insight**.

Disadvantages may apply for poor positioning, unarmed, in bad terrain, poor visibility, using a bow in close combat, etc. *Disadvantage cancels Advantage, simply roll 2d6.*

Easy / Hard

The Guide sets the Oracle target number as easy (6), normal (8), hard (10), or extreme (12). When possible, the Guide should compare Party Level with the Level of an opponent, monster, or challenge.

Sweet and Spicy

When any die rolls a 6, the outcome is "Sweet," adding a stylistic flair. Double 6s indicate a bonus or benefit. Conversely, if any die rolls a 1, the outcome is "Spicy," also adding style. Double 1s signify a penalty or complication.

Example: An archer snipes a sentry. On "spicy" another guard notices; on "sweet" the uniform is spotless.

The Guide can describe these effects or allow the player to provide their own interpretation. Unless the side effect is straightforward and minor, ask the Oracle if it happens. Characters must spend a Heart to attempt anything superhuman.

Time

Most of the game is a loose conversation between the players.

The Guide tracks 10-minute "Turns" using the "Turn Clock". This is a glass or metal bowl in the middle of the table. The Guide loudly tosses a die into the clock each time the

players do something time-consuming. When the bowl has six dice the Guide empties it and rolls the dice, looking for 1's, which indicate a complication of some kind. The Guide also rolls the Turn Clock whenever the players do something reckless..

The Turn Clock is just for slow-time, so it is paused during fast-paced situations such as combat.



Music

Music is important because it makes everything better. A character can perform once per Muster (1/day) for each music instrument **Skill** and song **Name**. A performance can influence NPC reactions or raise party morale. After 1 Turn (10 min.) ask the Oracle if the performance has lifted spirits; each person in the audience *recovers* 1 Heart (up to Hearts at Muster).

Each performance reaches an audience size up to the total of the Name level, instrument slots, and possibly instrument quality (“lute +1”) Higher level or group performances are more fun and may have additional benefits.

Names

Names are helpful for Insight and influencing NPCs. Characters can also spend 1 Heart to reenact the feat when they earned the Name.

Named Items

A **Named Item** has at least one Name (at most one per item slot). If equipped at all times, the character can use each Name once per Muster (1/day) at no Hearts cost.

Magic

Wândyr is full of magic, and much of the game is about exploring and meddling with magical secrets.

All magic in Wândyr involves *True Names*, either written or spoken as words of power. A True Name can provide a magic enhancement to an item, a sorcery to bind a spirit into a “sentient” item, a sigil for a magic-user spell, and much more.

All magic items and magical objects bear mystical inscriptions: sharp dwarven runes, flowing elven

script, or shifting arcane glyphs, only decipherable by *magic-users*.

Magic Items

Most magic items function as their mundane counterparts plus a magical enhancement. Elven boots silence footsteps, a hero's belt bestows strength, and a “shield +1” is extra protective. This often grants a Trait or Skill. Anyone with an appropriate Skill may discover their function through use (i.e. the qualities may be overlooked by the unskilled) and some items even require a Skill (e.g. spellbooks and Arcana require magic schools).



Sentient Items

Sentient items contain a bound soul of a magic-user, elemental, *d'jinn*, *ifr'it*, *kha'din*, dragon, eldar, deep one, or other entity. Bound spirits are notoriously capricious, jealous, and unhinged from confinement, their original dreams and ambitions maybe twisted by madness.

Sentient items are temperamental; when a character first attempts to use one, ask the Oracle if the item *accepts* them. On Sweet or Spicy, the item also talks to them!

A character who carries a sentient item grows in *alignment* and may discover deeper mysteries. They might take a personal **Name** such as "Wielder of Duskbringer". It's petty, but they *hate* anyone who offends their fragile egos, such as carrying them after being rejected, refusing to follow their agenda, abandoning, or "cheating" on them with a rival item.

Magic-Users

Magic is classified by "magic school", such as Vitae (life), Elemental, Thaumaturgy (control), Illusione (illusions & mental), Umbrakala (shadows & gates), or Necromantia.

A character with a **Magic School** is a "magic-user" literate in the magic language of that school. Words are

magical, and magic is formed by magic words, runes, glyphs, arcane script, etc.

Spell Casting

Casting a spell requires a Spellbook and one free hand. The caster must say the magic words loudly and precisely and pay 1 Heart.

The caster can spend more Hearts to *boost* the spell. However, the Guide will worry for the safety of the character if this is higher than Party Level or number of spells known in this magic school.



Magic Oracle

Ask the Oracle if a spellcasting matches the magic-user's *intention*. On "NO" *something unintended* happens (Sweet is close but flawed and Spicy is wildly different or dangerous). Ask the Oracle a question about what happened, and add to Lore. A "NO" is not a failure; the magic had a complication rather than simply matching the caster's intention.

Spell Duration

Each spell can be cast with a duration of either *Round* or *Turn*:

Round spells start and finish instantaneously.

Turn spells do not start instantaneously, but last for the current scene (e.g. a combat encounter or cutscene) or 10 min.

Learning Spells

A magic-user can *learn* a spell from a spellbook after casting it with *Sweet*. Upon paying 1 XP they gain the spell as a **Name** and no longer need the book to cast the spell. If they muster with the book they can cast once per Muster (1/day) at no Hearts. Alternatively, the magic-user may enchant an item, creating an **Arcana**. However, all this is undone if anyone else ever casts the spell from the spellbook.

Arcana

An Arcana is an item with one or more True Names of spells written on it. Arcana can be any kind of item (even tattoos) with magic-user "drip" based on the spell Names. If equipped at Muster, a magic-user can *ostentatiously* use each Name in an Arcana once per Muster (1/day), at no Hearts cost..

Magic Components

A Magic Component reduces this cost by 1 Heart per item slot consumed. *Magic components can be found in strange magical places.*



Magic-User Spell Lists

1 Vitae (Life)

Life force, growth, and harmony. The magic of the Elves, written in living ink that grows and changes like vines. The hallow channel beneficial energies, promote growth, and keep nature's balance.

- 1.1.1** *Animal Bond* - Form lasting connection
- 1.1.2** *Animal Friendship* - Benevolent control
- 1.1.3** *Balance Weave* - Unite opposites
- 1.1.4** *Beast Bond* - Create long-lasting bond
- 1.1.5** *Beast Form* - Friendly transformation
- 1.1.6** *Beast Speech* - Talk with animals

- 1.2.1** *Divine Grace* - Channel blessing
- 1.2.2** *Healing Touch* - Cure wounds
- 1.2.3** *Joy Song* - Lift spirits
- 1.2.4** *Life Bloom* - Encourage growth
- 1.2.5** *Light Shield* - Protect from evil
- 1.2.6** *Pacify* - Remove violence

- 1.3.1** *Peace Aura* - Calm violence
- 1.3.2** *Snail Knight* - Summon noble mount
- 1.3.3** *Star Guide* - Find true path
- 1.3.4** *Sun Beam* - Channel daylight
- 1.3.5** *Thicket* - Grow healthy plants
- 1.3.6** *Truth Sight* - See through lies

- 1.4.1** *Ward* - Create protective barrier
- 1.4.2** *Cure Disease* - Remove ailments
- 1.4.3** *Forest Touch* - Speak with plants
- 1.4.4** *Growing Script* - Living magical writing
- 1.4.5** *Nature's Blessing* - Enhance vitality
- 1.4.6** *Purification* - Remove toxins

- 1.5.1** *Regeneration* - Speed natural healing
- 1.5.2** *Heart Glyph* - Inscribe emotions
- 1.5.3** *Nature's Bounty* - Create food/water
- 1.5.4** *Pack Call* - Summon animal allies
- 1.5.5** *Vital Surge* - Boost life force
- 1.5.6** *Wild Empathy* - Share animal feelings

- 1.6.1** *Life Transfer* - Share vital force
- 1.6.2** *Nature's Rhythm* - Align with cycles
- 1.6.3** *Perfect Unity* - Complete balance
- 1.6.4** *Season's Call* - Control growth cycle
- 1.6.5** *Tranquil Heart* - Create inner peace
- 1.6.6** *Vital Harmony* - Balance life forces

2 Elemental (Elemental)

Primal forces, elements, and weather. The Baal inscribe dragon magic in burning runes carved in stone. Practitioners control weather, create barriers of ice and fire, command gravity, and shape elements.

- 2.1.1** *Control Weather* - Command climate
- 2.1.2** *Crystal Growth* - Form gems
- 2.1.3** *Dragon's Breath* - Channel flame
- 2.1.4** *Earth Shape* - Mold stone
- 2.1.5** *Earthquake* - Shake ground
- 2.1.6** *Element Master* - Complete control

- 2.2.1** *Elemental Wall* - Create barrier
- 2.2.2** *Fire Shield* - Protective flames
- 2.2.3** *Fog Cloud* - Create mist
- 2.2.4** *Force Wall* - Energy barrier
- 2.2.5** *Gravity Shift* - Change gravity
- 2.2.6** *Heat Metal* - Make objects burning

- 2.3.1** *Icy Touch* - Spread ice
- 2.3.2** *Increase Gravity* - Triple weight
- 2.3.3** *Lightning Strike* - Call electricity
- 2.3.4** *Liquid Air* - Make air swimmable
- 2.3.5** *Mist Form* - Become vapor
- 2.3.6** *Mountain's Strength* - Earth power

- 2.4.1** *Rain Make* - Create downpour
- 2.4.2** *Sculpt Elements* - Shape materials
- 2.4.3** *Steam Form* - Become vapor
- 2.4.4** *Stone Skin* - Harden flesh
- 2.4.5** *Stone Tell* - Read earth memories
- 2.4.6** *Storm Call* - Summon thunder

- 2.5.1** *Summon Cube* - Control earth
- 2.5.2** *Summon Idol* - Create statue
- 2.5.3** *Thunder Call* - Create sonic boom
- 2.5.4** *Tide Control* - Command waters
- 2.5.5** *Upwell* - Create spring
- 2.5.6** *Water Breathing* - Breathe liquid

- 2.6.1** *Water Shape* - Control liquid
- 2.6.2** *Web Weave* - Spin natural nets
- 2.6.3** *Whirlwind* - Create vortex
- 2.6.4** *Wind Shield* - Air protection
- 2.6.5** *Wind Walk* - Float on breeze
- 2.6.6** *Zephyr* - Ride the winds

3 Thaumaturgy (Control)

Physical laws, mechanisms, and force. The engineering magic of the Dwur, written in foundational runes that command reality. Practitioners control objects, manipulate energy, bind powers, and impose their will upon matter.

3.1.1 *Adhere* - Make sticky

3.1.2 *Animate Object* - Objects obey

3.1.3 *Astral Prison* - Crystal stasis

3.1.4 *Command* - Force obedience

3.1.5 *Elasticity* - Control form

3.1.6 *Filch* - Teleport items

3.2.1 *Force Push* - Directional power

3.2.2 *Haste* - Control speed

3.2.3 *Hover* - Control levitation

3.2.4 *Invisible Tether* - Bind objects

3.2.5 *Knock* - Open locks

3.2.6 *Leap* - Control jumping

3.3.1 *Lock* - Seal door

3.3.2 *Magic Suppressor* - Null magic

3.3.3 *Masterscript* - Write command runes

3.3.4 *Shrink Item* - Reduce size

3.3.5 *Sort* - Organize items

3.3.6 *Spider Climb* - Control climbing

3.4.1 *Strengthen* - Reinforce material

3.4.2 *Teleport* - Move objects

3.4.3 *Time Slip* - Control time

3.4.4 *Unravel* - Counter spells

3.4.5 *Augment Object* - Enhance item

3.4.6 *Control Device* - Command mechanisms

3.5.1 *Animate Tool* - Give purpose

3.5.2 *Binding Circle* - Contain force

3.5.3 *Density Control* - Alter mass

3.5.4 *Enhance Power* - Boost magic

3.5.5 *Mend* - Repair objects

3.5.6 *Object Memory* - Read item history

3.6.1 *Reality Anchor* - Stabilize space

3.6.2 *Rune Lock* - Seal with power

3.6.3 *Shape Material* - Change form

3.6.4 *Magic Circle* - Create workspace

3.6.5 *Thaumaturgic Seal* - Master rune

3.6.6 *Perfect Control* - Complete mastery

4 Illusione (Illusion)

Perception, thought, and dreams. The subtle magic of the Belerions, woven from phantasmal scripts that deceive the senses. Illusionists create illusions, alter memories, influence minds, and bend perceived reality.

4.1.1 *Arcane Eye* - Flying sensor

4.1.2 *Auditory Illusion* - Create sounds

4.1.3 *Bewitch* - Enchant mind

4.1.4 *Blur* - Distort appearance

4.1.5 *Charm* - Create friendship

4.1.6 *Detect Magic* - See magic

4.2.1 *Disguise* - Alter appearance

4.2.2 *Dream Message* - Send sleeping visions

4.2.3 *Dream Walking* - Enter dreams

4.2.4 *Duplicate* - Create copies

4.2.5 *Emotional Aura* - Project feeling

4.2.6 *False Memory* - Plant fake memory

4.3.1 *Feign Death* - Appear dead

4.3.2 *Greed* - Create obsession

4.3.3 *Hypnotize* - Question trance

4.3.4 *Illusory Spray* - Disorient with light

4.3.5 *Invisibility* - Become unseen

4.3.6 *Mass Suggestion* - Group command

4.4.1 *Major Image* - Perfect illusion

4.4.2 *Mind Maze* - Trap thoughts

4.4.3 *Mind Shield* - Protect thoughts

4.4.4 *Mirror Image* - Create duplicates

4.4.5 *Mirror Walk* - Step through glass

4.4.6 *Perfect Illusion* - Undetectable fake

4.5.1 *Phantom Sound* - Distant noise

4.5.2 *Phantasmal Force* - Moving illusion

4.5.3 *Programmed Illusion* - Triggered effect

4.5.4 *Read Mind* - Hear thoughts

4.5.5 *Scry* - Share vision

4.5.6 *Silent Image* - Create scene

4.6.1 *Spectacle* - Create grand illusion

4.6.2 *Telepathy* - Project thoughts

4.6.3 *True Seeing* - Pierce deception

4.6.4 *Vision* - Personal illusion

4.6.5 *Visual Illusion* - Static images

4.6.6 *X-Ray Vision* - See through matter

5 Umbrakallo (Shadow Gates)

Shadows, thresholds, and dimensional paths. The secret magic of the Alu, written in darkness and void. Practitioners create Kalla gates, walk between shadows, craft dimensional spaces, and traverse the boundaries between realms.

- 5.1.1** *Befuddle* - Shadow memories
- 5.1.2** *Body Swap* - Shadow exchange
- 5.1.3** *Cloak of Shadows* - Dark protection
- 5.1.4** *Dark Anchor* - Fix dimensional point
- 5.1.5** *Darksight* - See in darkness
- 5.1.6** *Deep Shadow* - Create pure darkness

- 5.2.1** *Dimension Door* - Create portal
- 5.2.2** *Disassemble* - Shadow-split form
- 5.2.3** *Gate Sense* - Detect portals
- 5.2.4** *Hatred* - Dark emotion
- 5.2.5** *Ice Heart* - Freeze with shadow
- 5.2.6** *Kalla Gate* - Create pocket realm

- 5.3.1** *Kallascript* - Write gate runes
- 5.3.2** *Masquerade* - Shadow dance
- 5.3.3** *Miniaturize* - Shrink into shadows
- 5.3.4** *Mind Shatter* - Shadow thoughts
- 5.3.5** *Night Sphere* - Create darkness
- 5.3.6** *Nightmare Seed* - Dark dreams

- 5.4.1** *Ooze Form* - Shadow substance
- 5.4.2** *Phantom Coach* - Shadow transport
- 5.4.3** *Plane Shift* - Change reality
- 5.4.4** *Realm Weave* - Connect spaces
- 5.4.5** *Shadow Bind* - Trap in darkness
- 5.4.6** *Shadow Clone* - Create dark duplicate

- 5.5.1** *Shadow Meld* - Merge with darkness
- 5.5.2** *Shadow Step* - Travel through dark
- 5.5.3** *Shadow Time* - Pause in darkness
- 5.5.4** *Shuffle* - Shadow displacement
- 5.5.5** *Smoke Form* - Become shadow
- 5.5.6** *Space Fold* - Bend dimensions

- 5.6.1** *Threshold Walk* - Pass through doors
- 5.6.2** *Twilight Veil* - Walk between worlds
- 5.6.3** *Void Gate* - Open dark portal
- 5.6.4** *Void Shield* - Dark protection
- 5.6.5** *Void Step* - Brief teleport
- 5.6.6** *Perfect Shadow* - Complete control

6 Necromantia (Death)

Death, spirits, and decay. The forbidden magic of the Avathars, inscribed in blood and bone. Practitioners bind spirits, animate dead, drain life force, and manipulate the boundary between life and death.

- 6.1.1** *Animate Skeleton* - Raise bones
- 6.1.2** *Black Sacrament* - Death ritual
- 6.1.3** *Blood Curse* - Sacrifice life
- 6.1.4** *Blood Track* - Follow wounds
- 6.1.5** *Bone Puppet* - Animate dead
- 6.1.6** *Bone Shield* - Skeletal armor

- 6.2.1** *Command Undead* - Control dead
- 6.2.2** *Comprehend Dead* - Dead languages
- 6.2.3** *Corpse Explosion* - Detonate dead
- 6.2.4** *Dark Blessing* - Death's power
- 6.2.5** *Death Gate* - Portal to underworld
- 6.2.6** *Death Touch* - Wither life

- 6.3.1** *Death Ward* - Protect from necrotic
- 6.3.2** *Doom Mark* - Mark for death
- 6.3.3** *Drain Life* - Steal vitality
- 6.3.4** *Fear Aura* - Death terror
- 6.3.5** *Ghost Bind* - Trap spirits
- 6.3.6** *Grave Mist* - Create death fog

- 6.4.1** *Life Sense* - Detect living
- 6.4.2** *Mass Animation* - Raise army
- 6.4.3** *Marble Madness* - Death's toys
- 6.4.4** *Pain Echo* - Share suffering
- 6.4.5** *Plague Wind* - Spread death
- 6.4.6** *Psychometry* - Read death echoes

- 6.5.1** *Raise Dead* - Create undead
- 6.5.2** *Sniff* - Smell death
- 6.5.3** *Soul Cage* - Trap essence
- 6.5.4** *Soul Rend* - Tear spirit
- 6.5.5** *Speak with Dead* - Question spirits
- 6.5.6** *Spirit Chains* - Bind ghost

- 6.6.1** *Spirit Form* - Become ghostly
- 6.6.2** *Truth Sense* - Death's truth
- 6.6.3** *Undead Sight* - See spirits
- 6.6.4** *Vampiric Touch* - Drain energy
- 6.6.5** *Wizard Mark* - Death runes
- 6.6.6** *Perfect Death* - Ultimate end

Invocations

Otherworldly beings can be called on by speaking their *True Names*.

Lore

Randomly generate new names. Players may ask the Oracle "have we heard of this being before?", "is this being aligned with Law?", etc. Anything learned becomes part of the known Lore of the being.

Invocations

A character can make an Invocation by loudly and formally calling the True Name of the being *thrice* and stating a request. The player asks the Oracle if they feel the being notices the request (on Sweet the being *likes* the request and on Spicy they *dislike* it).

If the being notices the request, the Guide follows existing Lore and asks the Oracle what the being does, if anything, and when, how, etc. The personality of the being and alignment of the character to the being matter a great deal.

Alignment

Upon making an Invocation, the character loses d6 Hearts and XP. The being spends the XP to bring the character further into alignment with them (ask the Oracle what happens).

Relics

Relics are sacred objects that serve as conduits to otherworldly beings. They can have Names, and speaking a Name with correct alignment activates a sacred power once per Muster (1/day). Similar to a sentient item, the being might also speak a Name. These Names are often oral tradition rather than written on the item, so a character may need to learn Lore about the being to discover the Names.

Monsters

Each monster (or trap, etc.) has a **Level** comparable to **Party Level**. The Oracle is "hard" if this is higher than Party Level; or "easy" if lower.

Level 0: giant rat, vermin, goblin

Level 1: orc, skeleton, deathskito

Level 2: zombie, ghoul, giant ant, slime

Level 3: wight, harpy, giant spider

Level 4: werewolf, ogre, huge slime

Level 5: mummy, minotaur, owlbeast

Level 6: troll, wyvern, spectre, manticores

Level 7: griffon, djinni, vampire

Level 9: chimera, giant

Level 10: golem, dragon

For more detail, the Guide can use OSR monsters or wing it as follows.

Weak pack/tribal monsters have d6 Hearts; leaders 2d6. A solitary "apex predator" monster has 2d6 or 3d6 Hearts per HD, multiple attacks, plus a deadly attack of 2d6 or 3d6, or d6 Hearts per Turn for HD+2 Turns (for paralysis, poison, petrification, etc).

Fighting

In each Turn, a character can Move and Attack (or take another action).

Move

A character can stand up OR move 40' (40 feet). Each impediment (e.g. Baggage, readying weapons, bad terrain, darkness) cuts this in half.

Attack

When a character attacks, ask the Oracle if they "hit". Each "hit" deals d6 Hearts. More lethal weapons may have a "plus" bonus, e.g. "greatsword +1". Attackers are open to counterattacks.

Defend

When a character is attacked or otherwise endangered, ask the Oracle if they avoid getting "hit". Armor and shields give 1 "iron" Heart per item slot, usable only against weapons. More protective armor may have a "plus" bonus, such as "shield +1".

When two opponents attempt melee attacks against each other, reduce hits to each other by 1 Heart.

Initiative

The Guide determines Turn order based on the situation, e.g. characters near the front of the party might be called before those in the rear, or characters who need to move to see what is happening.

Melee attacks go first and are usually simultaneous. However, when enemies approach from a distance, the weapon with the better reach (by item slots) has the "right of way" to attack first. Conversely, in close quarters combat (less than 10 feet of fighting space per person) the smaller weapon attacks first.

Hearts

Hearts act as plot armor; a character is not injured while they have Hearts. A character at 0 Hearts is injured but can recover in Camp. A character below 0 Hearts is *dying* and needs magic healing; when the Turn Clock clears, anyone below 0 Hearts immediately dies.



Saving Throws

When someone is exposed to a special effect (poison, petrification, breath, magic, paralyzation, etc.), ask the Oracle if they somehow avoid the "worst half" of the effect. On YES they take half the effect.

The Oracle

Ask a question and roll 2d6: if the total is 8 or higher the answer is "Yes", otherwise "No".

Always phrase the question for yes/no where the characters *want* to hear "Yes":

- "Do we find shelter?"
- "Is the sword magical?"
- "Do I hit the monster?"
- "Do I avoid the trap?"

Sweet & Spicy

When any die rolls a 6, the outcome is "Sweet," adding a stylistic flair. Double 6s indicate a bonus or benefit. Conversely, if any die rolls a 1, the outcome is "Spicy," also adding style. Double 1s signify a penalty or complication.



Insight

Insight is an opportunity to claim advantage. Players who follow Insight on a roll have Advantage. Roll d6 for Insight each Turn.

1 - TRAIT

The player described their approach to the roll according to their Traits.

2 - SKILL

Use a helpful item Skill; requires the item.

3 - ITEM

Use a helpful item. (Special items require a specialized item Skill, e.g. longbow, lockpicks, greatsword, spellbooks, wand, etc.)

4 - NAME

Use a relevant Name (byname, title, named item, spell). "Dragon Slayer" helps with dragon stuff.

5 - SONG

Use a Song (or story, poem, etc.) helpful for the action or morale.

6 - EFFORT

Apply more effort. Thus, not possible if carrying Baggage, making something look easy, maintaining stealth or subtlety, climbing, swimming, wrestling, etc.